



## The myth about robots

A thought-provoking on what little we know about bots is deep rooted in the make-believe: <http://dgit.in/1tsWBHL>



## History of Rubik's cube

Trace the very beginning of the history of the Rubik's cube. Did you know it was never meant to be a toy? <http://dgit.in/1onCTuW>

Smart SoHo

wired connection is simple but when wireless communication is to be considered then the investment into routers and access points to ensure every client is enjoying a low-latency connection increases.

**Cost of conversion** – If you choose to go with one particular model and then wish to shift to another, it isn't always the matter of installing a software and getting it over with. A thin client system requires a beefy server and such hardware isn't exactly cheap. If converting, a proper cost analysis must be done in order to ensure that you don't end up losing money instead of saving it in the long run.

## Usage scenarios

Most applications of thin client systems revolves around prioritising who gets what amount of processing power allotted to them. A simple approach is to have employees who aren't performing processor intensive tasks use thin client systems while those who need more power be given individual systems. Then there are systems which don't require the need for any individual systems like schools. Every client can be a thin client and all data can be stored on the server with ease. Microsoft advertises its Multipoint Server for this purpose since it gives students the familiar Windows interface but allows the educator to have complete control over everything that goes on in the class room. The educator can decide what to project onto individual screens and also monitor what each student is working on at the moment.

Workplaces that primarily operate via a browser like all data entry operations don't require machines that boast of moderately powerful hardware. Thin client systems are perfect for such operations.

Similarly, when employees have to perform on-site work then can simply carry a wireless terminal with them that can be

used to connect to the server in the office. These wireless terminals often use SSDs and have no moving parts which makes them quite rugged. However, these mobile terminals are plagued with connectivity issues no matter which form of wireless medium they are on.

## Do you need to invest in thin clients?

At the moment customers don't have much choice when it comes to picking a thin client system since very few manufacturers offer these devices. The clients are often powered by a Celeron or Atom processor and have multiple display ports



Thin and zero clients are catching up fast

attached to it, each enabling one station. These devices are quite underpowered and the average worker might find the experience cumbersome and a good portion of the IT administrator's time would be spent educating employees over and over again.

A different approach can always be undertaken which doesn't hold true to a thin client system's definition. The old client server model is still better. The server in this case is beefy and each individual client is moderately powerful. But the server isn't a single computer

but a cluster of many machines that portrays itself in a single image. The computing power of a cluster allows users to run intensive operations on the cluster while the individual machine is used for something else. This approach works way better than thin client systems across many aspects and can service a lot many more employees with minimal investment. As and when more processing power is needed more computers can be added to the cluster. However, power consumption is a huge drawback of this system. This model is best suited for the majority of the work scenarios while thin clients are suited for low power consumption and low processing power needs.

## PCoIP

One step ahead of the thin client technology is PCoIP. It's a proprietary technology but mainstream brands have come out with products for the same. Another term used to describe this is "Zero-client" technology. The setup consists of a monitor which has one ethernet port and two USB ports for a keyboard and a mouse. Extra USB ports or card readers have been seen on certain models. The device uses PoE (Power over Ethernet) to deliver up to 40W which helps power the display and the hardware connected to the device but most of the devices we've come across does make use of a separate power connector. It's simply a remote desktop with all the processing happening over at the server. Video and data is channeled via ethernet which has more than enough capacity to handle the two. QoS settings enable a smooth display experience.

Thin and Zero clients are catching up given all cost benefits they offer, let us know if you are thinking of adopting the same for your SOHO. 



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